

Adam Gilchrist



HEMAN CHAWLA

Bishen Singh Bedi



BANDEEP SINGH

"Sledging is a mark of respect for rivals"

ADAM GILCHRIST

FORMER AUSTRALIAN WICKET-KEEPER

I would like to just acknowledge a few current issues that seem to be around. Without disrespecting the issues of Twenty20 and IPL and what effect they are going to have on world cricket, I would like to take a positive approach. Umpiring and technology, players' behaviour, sledging, the issues around this Australian summer, the money coming into the game, trans-national rivalries, cultures, east-west divide... I feel these issues are going to be around as long as cricket is played. I classify them as day-to-day, game-to-game, series-to-series issues that will crop up. Some of them have been well and truly around for 20-30 years. There was a great fear, when one day cricket arrived, whether it was going to cannibalise Test cricket. It hasn't.

Similarly, I believe Twenty20 is going to enhance the game; it has the potential, if used wisely and administered well to en-

hance cricket at all levels. It can help to give financial buoyancy to countries like the West Indies, help their boards to utilise resources, give them funds to make sure that their Test cricket survives. Debating issues, sometimes you cannot see the trees from the forest. I am looking at these issues as trees; I want to look at the forest, at a bigger picture, that is world cricket.

The Border-Gavaskar Trophy is truly the highest profile Test match series today. In 12 years of international cricket I found the greatest struggles, the greatest sense of relief and sense of achievement in contests against India. With that great rivalry we are always going to get a lot of desire, get sparks flying, we are going to have a cultural clash. We are going to have lot of energy going into the young players representing their countries and trying to win.

In an ironic way, sledging and verbal jesting, are quite a complement to your opponent. It is an acknowledgment that

you fear them, feel threatened by the challenge they pose. It's a weird way to do it but you are almost showing each other respect. The players have a responsibility not to cross the line as we like to say, but I think that there is a great responsibility for administrators and even the press to make sure that they don't try to over-regulate natural behaviour in trying to push away the emotion that we see on the cricket field.

"I HAVE FELT THE GREATEST SENSE OF ACHIEVEMENT AND RELIEF IN CONTESTS AGAINST INDIA."

Adam Gilchrist